

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PEDAGOGY & CURRICULUM FRAMEWORKS

Second Language: English in India

English is considered as a second language in India because every educational system has certain objectives which aim at bringing about the desired changes in the pupil. The success of learning can be judged only in terms of the changes brought about by this experience.

English has become a world language because the number of people who use English as a means of Communication exceeds much more than the number of people who speak it as a mother tongue. English was a primary language for barely 2.3 lakh Indians at the time of the census, while more than 86 million use it as their second language and another 39 million as their third language.

Key Points for English as a Second Language in India:

1. Generally, English is used among Indians as a **"link language"**. It is the first language for many well-educated Indians.
2. It is also the second language for many who speak more than one language in India. The English language is a tie that helps in binding many segments of our society together.
3. The English language has a great reach and influence and is taught all over the world.
4. English even today continues to act as an indispensable "link language". English represents better education, better culture, and better intellect in the Indian mind.
5. It is still freely used in administration, judiciary, education, and even for literary purposes in India.

The Aim of Teaching English as a Second Language

Language is a medium of communication. English is a powerful vehicle of communication that serves as a link language in a multicultural and multilingual society like India, and also acts as a global linguistic mediator.

Objectives of Teaching English as a Second Language:

- Enhancing vocabulary
- Motivating students
- Providing linguistic competence
- Developing imagination and creativity
- Developing grammatical structures
- Assisting in using the internet

The Four Specific Objectives of Teaching English:

1. To understand spoken English
2. To speak English
3. To understand written English
4. To write English

Importance of English Language as a Second Language

- Ability to use reference material such as dictionaries, etc.
- In most countries, it is not an official language but currently it is often taught as a foreign language.
- To be able to speak English fluently and accurately.
- In the modern world, knowledge of the English language has become a paralinguistic requirement for professional development.
- To think in English and then speak.
- To be able to talk in English.
- It serves a major purpose in changing or motivating student behavior.
- It should relate to the changes expected in the pupil rather than being viewed merely as the duties of the teachers.
- English plays an important and significant role right from the primary classes.

Principles of Second Language Teaching

1. Use the language experience approach to promote both oral and written communication.
2. Provide meaningful writing opportunities.
3. Teach note-taking skills.
4. Involve students in journal writing.
5. Every word or phrase should be correctly identified and repeated multiple times to obtain the highest scores/retention.
6. Various studies suggest that most learners need between 5 to 16 contacts with a word in order to retain it.

Factors Affecting Second Language Learning

There are many general factors that influence or affect second language learning, classified broadly as:

1. Developmental
2. Socioeconomic
3. Psychological

1. Developmental Factors

As individuals develop, there are different opportunities for learning. Learning is most effective when differential development within and across physical, intellectual, emotional, and social domains is taken into account. Developmental factors play an important role in learning. Development is the process of potentiality becoming actuality. Developmental factors which affect learning English include the following:

- **i) Motivation:** Motivation is one of the most important factors in second language learning. It is obvious that learners who want to learn are likely to achieve more than those who do not. Motivation is distinguished into two parts: intrinsic (internal) and extrinsic (external).
 - *Internal motivation:* Activities for which there is no apparent reward except the activity itself.
 - *External motivation:* Behaviors where individuals expect a reward, for example, money, praise, or positive feedback.
- **ii) Attitude:** Attitude consists of a set of beliefs about factors such as the target language culture, their own culture, and, in the case of classroom learning, their teachers and the learning tasks they are given.
- **iii) Age:** Age is one of the key factors that influence second language learning. It is generally believed that children are better at language learning than adults.
- **iv) Intelligence:** Intelligence is the general ability to master academic skills. It is defined and measured in terms of linguistic and logical-mathematical abilities. Studies show a strong relationship between intelligence and the acquisition of a foreign language, but primarily where academic skills are concerned.
- **v) Aptitude:** Aptitude refers to the specific ability a learner has for learning a second language. This aptitude is thought to be a combination of various abilities, such as the ability to identify sound patterns in a new language and the ability to recognize the different grammatical functions of words and sentences.
- **vi) Learning Styles:** Learning style is also called cognitive style. It is the particular way in which a learner tries to learn something.
- **vii) Personality:** Personality has been described as a set of features that characterize an individual. Its concept is difficult to define and measure due to its highly complicated nature.

2. Socio-economic Factors

A learner's attitude towards the second language and the opportunities a learner can obtain are heavily determined by their socioeconomic class. Specific social factors that can affect second language learning include age, gender, etc.

3. Psychological Factors

Psychological factors suggest that individual meaning is a developmental phenomenon and can happen in a variety of unique ways, depending on the individual student's background and patterns of responses. It is also a sociological construct because it considers the way that power, the economy, and political and social factors affect how groups of people come to a common understanding of formal learning in their world.

National Curriculum Framework (NCF 2005)

The National Curriculum Framework 2005 was finalized through marathon discussions among education experts. It has long historical roots. Previous experiences gained in the field of teaching-learning processes were deliberately discussed and considered.

The entire NCF 2005 document is divided into five chapters:

1. The First chapter presents the perspective of the NCF 2005.
2. The Second chapter defines the process of learning and knowledge formation.
3. The Third chapter describes the areas of the curriculum included within it.
4. The Fourth chapter includes the school and classroom environment, which are critical for the proper transaction of the teaching-learning process.
5. The Fifth chapter outlines systemic reforms for the document and educational structure.

Guiding Principles of NCF 2005:

1. Connecting knowledge to life outside the school.
2. Ensuring that learning shifts away from rote methods.
3. Enriching the curriculum to ensure the overall development of children rather than remaining textbook-centric.
4. Making examinations more flexible and integrating them into classroom life.
5. Nurturing an over-riding identity informed by caring concerns within the democratic polity of the country.

Bihar Curriculum Framework (BCF 2008)

The Bihar Curriculum Framework 2008 was inspired by the NCF 2005. It mainly emphasizes education contextually linked with the social conditions where children live, recognizing them as important factors in the development of an individual and society. It states that society can be developed when the majority of people attend school-level education.

When the school becomes a mere value transformation hub, it could marginalize the opportunity for the transformation of knowledge in systematic and proper ways. BCF 2008 also focuses on democratic values of equality, justice, secularism, and social values. Therefore, the curriculum is designed to address the challenges raised due to the social context of education both at the planning and implementation levels.

Recognizing that the standard systems at the primary and upper primary levels in Bihar required major enhancement, the Bihar government created this state-specific document.

BCF 2008 focus areas:

1. Values and Ideals:

- Equality of status and opportunity.
- Freedom of thought, expression, belief, faith, and worship.
- Autonomy of mind as independence of thinking based on reason.

- Care and respect for others, going beyond respecting their freedom and autonomy to a deep concern for the well-being and sensitivity to all members of society.

2. Capabilities of Individual Human Beings:

- A knowledge base encompassing all crucial areas of social-political life and all basic ways of investigation and validation of knowledge.
- Sensitivity to others' well-being and feelings, coupled with knowledge, forming the basis of a rational commitment to values that encompass all life forms.
- Critical rationality as the only way to autonomy of thought and action.
- Recognizing that future needs for the development of knowledge, reason, sensitivity, and skills cannot be fully determined in advance.

Curriculum and Syllabus

Curriculum: The main goal of teaching is to properly transact the goals of the subject envisaged in the curriculum. The curriculum's blueprint visualizes development at the national level. States consider the national-level curriculum in the context of their own situation and finalize a relevant curriculum at the state level.

Syllabus: The curriculum is a more abstract document than the syllabus. The curriculum framework has a wide range of work in the fields of education, dealing with all aspects of the educational system and including all learning experiences as a whole. Conversely, the syllabus is a narrower term. The syllabus deals with activities of a specific period, defining the content of a particular subject for a particular time in a year.

Key Differences Between Curriculum and Syllabus:

Curriculum	Syllabus
I. It is a complete thought.	I. It is a limited thought.
II. It is prescriptive.	II. It is descriptive.
III. It prescribes the objectives.	III. It describes how to achieve the objective.
IV. It includes all activities.	IV. It is related to a particular subject.
V. It is applicable to the institutions.	V. It is applicable to the class.

Textbooks: Textbooks are written on the basis of the syllabus. In brief, textbooks are the manifestation or draft of the syllabus. The textbook starts its journey from the curriculum framework and syllabus, ending in its completed form as a textbook.

Approaches for Teaching English

In English Language Teaching (ELT), there are three key terms used: **approach, method, and technique**. A clear distinction was made by Edwin Anthony among these terms with specific reference to language learning. An approach is a way of looking at teaching and learning.

- **Behaviourist Approach:** This theory of learning states that all behaviors are learned through interaction with the environment through a process called conditioning. It is also known as behavioral psychology. It views psychology as a purely objective, experimental branch of natural science whose theoretical goal is prediction and control. The components of a theory should be as simple as possible, proposing the use of operational definitions. It posits that an individual can be motivated to action by something outside of themselves (e.g., getting a new car motivates a teenager to graduate, or getting money motivates an adult to go to work). Behaviourism focuses on observing and analyzing how controlled environmental changes affect behavior.
- **Structural Approach:** This approach means the arrangement of words in such a way as to form a suitable pattern or sentence structure. Mastery of sentence structure is considered more critical than the mere acquisition of vocabulary. Content words are taught directed by their usefulness, simplicity, and teachability. Appropriate situations should be created to practice the structure, relate its meaning to it, and build up a vocabulary of content words while structures are taught systematically.

Principles of the Structural Approach:

1. Extensive oral work is essential for the proper drilling of basic structures.
 2. It emphasizes proper loud reading by students.
 3. Teachers must give adequate attention to the pronunciation of pupils.
 4. Teachers should use cards, charts, tables, etc., for teaching, reading, and application.
 5. Teachers should know how to draw substitution tables and use them for drilling in both writing and speaking.
- **Communicative Approach (CLT):** Communicative Language Teaching emphasizes interaction as both the means and the ultimate goal of study. It is based on the idea that learning language successfully comes through having to communicate real meaning. The main objective is to present a topic in a context as natural as possible.
- Role of the Teacher in CLT:*
1. The manager of classroom activities.
 2. Responsible for establishing situations wisely to promote communication.
 3. Assisting learners by providing frameworks, patterns, and rules to develop communicative language skills.
- **Cognitive Approach:** A perspective on learning that rejects the old behaviorist perspective and audio-visual methods that laid too much emphasis on peripheral psychological mechanisms, though its references to meaning and context remain positive. It arose not as an explicit teaching method but as a reaction to structuralism and behavioral principles, introducing concepts of universality, creativity, and innateness.
 - **Constructivist Approach:** This approach believes that people construct their own knowledge on the basis of observation, understanding, and experience. Students engage in activities to construct knowledge actively rather

than gaining it passively. It is student-centered, and the teacher acts as a facilitator.

Principles of the Constructivist Approach:

1. The teacher acts as a guide who facilitates learning by creating conducive situations.
2. Self-construction of knowledge leads to better learning and retention.
3. It develops higher-order thinking skills.
4. It builds new knowledge on the foundation of previous knowledge.
5. It is based on comprehensive assessment.

Unit 02: Strategies for Teaching Language Skills (Listening & Speaking)

Listening Skill

Listening is receiving language through the ears. It requires focus and attention, and is a skill that some people need to work harder at than others. People who have difficulty concentrating are typically poor listeners. Listening to a second language requires even greater focus.

Sound Recognition: Listening and analyzing sound may seem simple to the human mind, but it is the end product of a complicated chain of events. A concept is formulated in the speaker's brain, speech organs create disturbances in the air as sound waves, and these waves are received by the ears of the listener.

- **Pre-listening Activities:** Things learners do before a listening task to prepare. Purposes include pre-teaching vocabulary, activating schema, predicting content, and generating interest. Examples: discussion questions, true/false statements, brainstorming, and vocabulary work.
- **While-listening Activities:** Tasks students complete during the listening phase to help them develop the skill of eliciting messages from spoken language. These tasks show understanding and should be inherently interesting to maintain engagement.
- **Post-listening Activities:** All work related to a listening text done after completion. Some are extensions of pre- or while-listening work, while others relate loosely to the text for wider production.

Linguistic Concepts: Syllable, Stress & Intonation

Syllable: A unit of sound; a segment of uninterrupted speech typically produced with a single puff of air from the lungs.

- *One-syllable words:* ace, big, black, cool, right, rough, etc.
- *Two-syllable words:* able, alive, apple, away, even, women, etc.
- *Three-syllable words:* abducting, accurate, animal, etc.
- *Four-syllable words:* admirable, avocado, anonymous, complicated, etc.

Stress: The emphasis applied to pronounce a particular part of a word using different vocal forces. Types include: Syllable stress, Word stress, and Sentence stress. For example, in the word *dictionary*, emphasis is placed on the first part ("Dict").

Intonation: Indicates the high or low pitch of words/sentences in different situations. The level of pitch determines the meaning and indicates the real mood of the speaker. Intonation indicates: contexts, situations, attitude, emotions, statements, and questions.

Rhythm: A regular series of sounds or movements. Rhythm means reading with stress at regular intervals to produce a metrical effect (e.g., in verse, prose, music, or motion).

Speaking Skill

Speaking is the delivery of language through the mouth using many parts of our body, including the lungs, vocal tract, vocal cords, tongue, teeth, and lips.

- **Reciting a Poem:** The act of reciting from memory or a formal reading of verse/writing before an audience. In academia, it demonstrates knowledge or provides instruction. A student recites poems or essays verbatim to a teacher, tutor, or class.
- **Participating in a Dialogue / Conversation:** Dialogue literally means "talk between two people". Dialogue writing is a highly useful form of composition for gaining command over spoken English, introducing colloquial English expressions and easy, natural constructions.
- **Greetings:** An act of communication in which human beings intentionally make their presence known to each other to show attention and suggest a relationship or social status (formal/informal). Examples: *Namaste/Namaskar* in Hindi; *Hello/Hi* in English.
- **Asking & Answering Questions:** The most common method of assessing and promoting comprehension. The nature of questions influences the thought processes children use to respond.
- **Conveying Information:** Information refers to facts carrying meaning via text, numbers, images, audio, or video. Communication is the primary activity of conveying this information.

Tools and Techniques of Assessment

- **Teacher-made and Standardized Tests:** Used to measure in numeric terms the scores of students across subjects.
- **Observation:** The most commonly employed technique to evaluate student progress and behavior.
- **Checklist:** A list of action items, steps, or elements needed for a task, checked off as completed.
- **Interview:** An evaluation method to gather information, assess experiences, abilities, and interpersonal skills.
- **Aptitude Tools:** Used to measure the potential performance and specific innate abilities of students.
- **Learning Plan:** A comprehensive, customized multi-day plan for instruction and assessment aligned to learning outcomes and standards.
- **Learning Indicators:** Formulated to identify fundamental knowledge and skills around which to guide explicit instruction and scaffold support.

Unit 03: Strategies for Teaching Reading and Writing

Reading Skills

Reading is the process of taking in the sense or meaning of letters, symbols, etc., especially by sight or touch. It is a multifaceted process involving word recognition.

- **Loud Reading:** Reading aloud. In early development up to around the eighth grade, a student's listening level significantly surpasses their reading level. It involves text above independent reading level but matching their listening level.
- **Silent Reading:** Reading slowly to oneself without pronouncing words aloud. Studies indicate students given time for silent reading achieve significantly better grades and comprehension.
- **Skimming:** Reading a piece of writing very quickly to gain a general overview or the main idea without focusing on specific words or phrases.
- **Scanning:** Looking through written material rapidly to locate specific, targeted pieces of important or interesting information.
- **Pre-Reading Strategies:** Activities that prepare students to read a selection (e.g., previewing headings, surveying illustrations, reading summaries, formulating questions).
- **While-Reading Strategies:** Active strategies used during reading to maintain comprehension (e.g., questioning, predicting, visualizing, paraphrasing).
- **Post-Reading Strategies:** Follow-up steps to think over the text, confirm predictions, and answer review questions.

Conveying Information via Structured Formats

Information can be conveyed directly or indirectly through written outputs such as:

[College Name] [Department of Examination] Date: _____ NOTICE FOR PRACTICAL All the students of 1st, 3rd & 5th Semester are hereby informed that their practical examinations have been scheduled to be held from _____ to _____ at the college campus. Principal: _____ College: _____

- **Advertisement:** An announcement online, in newspapers, on television, or via posters to showcase a product, event, or job, carefully structured to catch the reader's eye.

- **Article Writing:** Structured to include an Introduction, Causes, Statistics, Advantages/Disadvantages, and a robust Conclusion with an advisory message or warning.
- **Invitations:** Written or oral requests for social functions (birthdays, weddings, promotions) that act as an important component of social relations.

The Writing Process

1. **Brainstorming (Prewriting):** The planning phase involving gathering ideas, outlining, diagrams, mapping thoughts, and determining the thesis statement based on audience and purpose.
2. **Mind Map:** A structured, hierarchical strategy for making notes on a topic prior to writing.
3. **Drafting:** Putting ideas into complete sentences and paragraphs to form a cohesive rough draft.
4. **Evaluation Plan:** An integral component providing feedback to refine a project during implementation.
5. **Reviewing:** Reconstructing content by adding, deleting, or reorganizing points to make the tone, style, and content appropriate for the target audience.
6. **Editing:** Checking the rough draft systematically for mechanical and grammatical errors (capitalization, punctuation, spelling).

Unit 04: Teaching Vocabulary and Grammar in Context

Strategies for Vocabulary Teaching

Effective vocabulary teaching requires looking at text from the student's perspective, tailoring instruction through engaging practices rather than assuming prior literacy exposure.

Important Ways to Teach Vocabulary:

- Make direct vocabulary instruction highly engaging and fun.
- Consider smooth transitions between various grammatical forms.
- Have students develop their own connections, illustrations, and examples.
- Create quality opportunities for active vocabulary practice.

Engaging Classroom Activities:

1. Bingo Game	6. Spelling Games
2. Antakshari (Word Chains)	7. Dictation
3. Idioms & Meanings	8. Anagrams
4. Matching Words & Meanings	9. Scrambling Words
5. Scrabble	10. Crossword Puzzles

Grammar in Context

Grammar in context is a pedagogical method where grammar is embedded and integrated seamlessly into creative writing and analytical reading rather than being taught as an isolated standalone activity. This approach provides learners with an organic opportunity to understand how language functions, ultimately improving their communicative competence.